HireOrGetHired (HOGH) — VC-Grade 10-Slide Elevator Pitch Deck

Tagline: *The intelligence layer that prepares both sides for the hire—without replacing the human moment.*

Sources: `assignment.md`, `docs/md/product_note.md`, `docs/md/submission.md`, `docs/md/research.md`

Live demo: Use the **Live demo interlude** block below as **one full-screen slide** (or second "click" on Slide 5). Place it **after Slide 5**, then **return to Slide 6** (Differentiation). For a **strict 10-slide** file count, merge that layout into the bottom of Slide 5 instead of adding an 11th file slide.

Slide 1 — Title & Hook

1. Objective

Establish instant credibility, name the category, and anchor one memorable promise.

2. Context and message

HOGH is a **dual-sided Agentic AI platform** for talent acquisition: a persistent **Second Brain** for recruiters (**TalentAgent™**) and for job seekers (**CareerAgent™**). You are **not** replacing ATS—you sit **above** the stack as orchestration + intelligence.

3. Data / facts to use

- Course context: Gen AI business problem + implementable roadmap + ROI (assignment weight **40%**).
- Positioning line: *"AI handles everything around the human moments; the human moments stay sacred."*

4. What this slide is about (lasting message)

Open with clarity and ambition: hiring's bottleneck isn't lack of tools—it's **fragmented intelligence** and **asymmetric preparation**. HOGH owns the narrative that **both** parties deserve agentic support, then meet as informed humans. The audience should leave remembering **one company name**, **one category** (agentic intelligence layer for hiring), and **one principle** (amplify judgment, don't replace it).

Slide 2 — The Problem (Dual-Sided Crisis)

1. Objective

Prove the problem is **large, expensive, and structurally broken** on **both** sides.

2. Context and message

Employers suffer **slow fills**, **high cost-per-hire**, and **recruiter time** sunk in logistics. Candidates suffer **opacity**, **low response**, and **negotiation disadvantage**. Incumbent stacks are **siloed** (sourcing vs ATS vs scheduling)—no unified autonomous layer from requisition to offer.

3. Data / facts to use

- **42 days** average time-to-fill; **$4,700+** direct recruiting cost per hire (role-dependent up to **~$28K** all-in).
- **~60%+** recruiter time on repetitive tasks (sourcing, scheduling, admin).
- **73%** of job seekers report poor/opaque application experience.
- **2–4%** application response rates; **~5.1 months** average search duration.
- **57%** accept first offer; **$5K–$15K** commonly left on table.
- **78%** ATS adoption but **94%** of candidate profiles never re-surfaced.
- Agentic HR AI market **~$2.5B (2023)** → **~$23.2B by 2034**, **~35% CAGR** (research—cite as analyst-sourced in deck footnotes).

4. What this slide is about (lasting message)

This is a **systems problem**, not a UI problem: data exists, but **no one synthesizes it end-to-end** for **both** recruiter and candidate. The takeaway: **huge pain + clear waste** → room for a **new architectural layer**, not another point tool.

Slide 3 — The Solution (HOGH in One Breath)

1. Objective

Show **what you built** and **how it changes outcomes** in plain language.

2. Context and message

TalentAgent™ automates research, logistics, and synthesis; delivers **Candidate Intelligence Brief™** before interviews. **CareerAgent™** runs continuous opportunity intelligence, applications (with approval), interview prep, and offer coaching; delivers **Opportunity Intelligence Brief™** before interviews. **NegotiationCoach™** gives **private, real-time** guidance during **human-to-human** offer talks. **Human Handoff Protocol™** defines where AI stops and humans decide.

3. Data / facts to use

- **Human-centered pipeline:** intelligence gathering → match/outreach (with approvals) → pre-interview briefs → **human interview** → offer with **AI advisory** → post-hire retention.
- Pilot-style industry benchmarks (research): **30–45%** time-to-fill reduction; **2×** outreach response vs templates; **40%** scheduling friction reduction; **+15 NPS** for scheduling bots—use as **category validation**, not yet HOGH-specific claims.

4. What this slide is about (lasting message)

HOGH is **opposite** "AI replaces recruiters/candidates." The product is **preparation at scale** + **compliance-friendly gates**. Audience remembers: **two agents, two briefs, humans in the room for the decisions that matter.**

Slide 4 — Why Now (Market & Adoption Tailwinds)

1. Objective

Create **urgency**: technology + regulation + buyer behavior align for **agentic orchestration**.

2. Context and message

Enterprises are moving from **generative copilots** to **multi-agent workflows**. Capital is flowing to agentic HR. Regulation (GDPR, CCPA, **EU AI Act** high-risk hiring) **rewards** documented human oversight—not black-box automation.

3. Data / facts to use

- **~38%** of Fortune 500 HR departments with **≥1 agentic recruiting module by Q3 2025** vs **7% in 2022** (research).
- VC: **~$1.9B** into agentic HR AI **2022–2025** (research).
- **EU AI Act:** recruitment as **high-risk** → **human-in-the-loop** (aligns product design).

4. What this slide is about (lasting message)

Window is open: buyers are piloting agents, budgets exist, and **governance-first** vendors win enterprise. HOGH isn't an early science project—it's **timely infrastructure** for how hiring **must** work under modern AI law and board risk oversight.

Slide 5 — Product: How It Works (Dual "Second Brain")

1. Objective

Make the **architecture intuitive**: sub-agents, orchestration, and **evidence-backed** outputs.

2. Context and message

TalentAgent™ network: RadarAgent (sourcing), IntelligenceAgent (360° brief), OutreachAgent (+ RL on responses), ScreenAgent, SchedulerAgent, OfferAgent, RetentionAgent—**ReAct-style** orchestration with **approval gates** (shortlist, outreach, offers). **CareerAgent™:** DiscoveryAgent, ApplicationAgent, SkillMapAgent (ESCO/O*NET), OpportunityIntelligenceAgent, InterviewCoachAgent, NegotiationAdvisorAgent, CareerPathAgent.

3. Data / facts to use

- Briefs include **provenance** (claims linked to sources); verification flags for gaps/tenure.
- **Skills evidence map** pattern: claimed skills backed by concrete public evidence (e.g., repos, commits, certifications).

4. What this slide is about (lasting message)

Investors and evaluators see **serious engineering**: not one chatbot—a **specialist agent mesh** with **explicit handoffs**. Lasting impression: **depth** (RAG, taxonomy, calendars, APIs) matches the **story** (human-

centered).

Live demo segue (callout — end of Slide 5)

- **When to break out:** Right after this slide (architecture is set; audience is ready to *see* the product).
- **Spoken bridge:** *"That's the architecture—now **30–60 seconds live** on the **online demo** so you're not only seeing boxes and agents. Then we'll come **straight back** to the deck for **why this is defensible** and the business."*
- **After demo:** Advance to **Slide 6** with: *"Back to the story—**moat and competition**."*
- **Concrete asset:** Use the **Live demo interlude** section (next) as your deck slide; replace the URL with your real hosted link (e.g. production/staging site or `index.html` deployment).

Live demo interlude — *one slide; after Slide 5, then resume Slide 6*

Use this as a **dedicated slide** in Keynote/PowerPoint/Google Slides/PDF: big type, low clutter, so the room focuses on **your screen share** of the live site.

Slide objective

Create a **clean break** for an online walkthrough; anchor the URL/QR; make the **return path** obvious ("we pick up at differentiation / moat").

On-slide content (suggested)

- **Headline: Live demo — HireOrGetHired**
- **Subline:** *TalentAgent™ · CareerAgent™ · briefs & flows (pick 1–2 paths to show)*
- **Primary CTA:** `<YOUR_LIVE_DEMO_URL>` ← replace (e.g. `https://…` or course submission URL)
- **Optional:** QR code → same URL
- **Footer:** *~1 min · then back to deck*

Presenter script (short)

1. *"I'm switching to the **browser**—everything you're about to see is the **live** experience."*
2. *(Demo: e.g. landing → one agent surface → one brief or flow—keep it tight.)*
3. *"**Back to the deck**—next: **why this isn't 'just another HR tool'** and how we **compound**."* → **Slide 6**

Lasting message

They remember you **shipped something clickable**, not only a narrative—without derailing the VC arc because you **explicitly close the loop** into moat and business slides.

Slide 6 — Differentiation & Moat

1. Objective

Answer "**Why not LinkedIn / HireEZ / ATS AI features?**"

2. Context and message

Category	Limitation	HOGH
AI sourcing	Recruiter-only, reactive	**Dual-sided** persistent agents
Interview bots	Automates human out	**Interview always human**
Career tools	Static tips	**Agentic** apply + prep + negotiation

Moat path: **Talent Intelligence Graph™** compounds with anonymized platform data + external signals; workflow integration above Greenhouse/Workday; **NegotiationCoach™** as high-trust differentiator.

3. Data / facts to use

- Competitive landscape: ATS/job boards, AI sourcing, interview automation, career coaching apps, recruiter-only agentic platforms (see submission).
- Patent / defensibility angles: Human Handoff Protocol™, dual private negotiation advisory, graph + brief generation—frame as **defensibility roadmap**.

4. What this slide is about (lasting message)

Category creation: "dual Second Brain + human sacred moments." Moat is **data flywheel + compliance depth + network effects** (both sides), not a single feature.

Slide 7 — Go-to-Market & Business Model

1. Objective

Show **how you win customers** and **how you make money** credibly.

2. Context and message

Enterprise-first to solve cold-start: paid recruiter contracts create real hiring velocity that makes **CareerAgent™** valuable. Consumer growth seeded via **universities / professional communities**. Revenue streams: **B2B SaaS** (seats, requisitions), **Talent Intelligence API**, **consumer subscription** over time.

3. Data / facts to use

- **14 FTE** Year 1 plan (6 ML/AI, 3 backend, PM, sales, legal/compliance, UX, CEO)—roadmap section.
- **Customer-level ROI (enterprise): ~143% Year 1** with **~$258K net annual value** (submission model—present as illustrative cohort).

4. What this slide is about (lasting message)

Disciplined dual-sided GTM: **sell the painkiller to CHRO/recruiting ops**, use activity to **earn** candidate-side engagement. Buyers hear **payback logic**, not vanity AI.

Slide 8 — Roadmap (Credibility & Sequencing)

1. Objective

Prove **implementability** and **milestone discipline** (aligns with course rubric).

2. Context and message

Year 1 — Foundation: MVP employer value, **depth over breadth** (e.g., **one ATS** integration focus—Greenhouse depth in Y1 narrative), pilot customers, compliance/audit foundations. **Year 2 — Scale:** expand integrations, geographic motion, stronger consumer funnel. **Year 3 — Lead:** platform leadership, multi-stream revenue, advanced graph leverage.

3. Data / facts to use

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
ARR	**~$850K**	**~$4.0M**	**~$17.9M**

Use quarterly milestones from `submission.md` §5 in the spoken track.

4. What this slide is about (lasting message)

Sequenced bets that de-risk engineering and sales. Audience thinks: **this team knows how to ship enterprise software.**

Slide 9 — Financials, ROI & The Ask

1. Objective

Show **unit economics mindset**, **path to profit**, and **capital efficiency**; close with **ask**.

2. Context and message

Present **ARR**, **gross margin expansion**, **EBITDA trajectory**, and **breakeven timing** as **funded growth**. Anchor **Series A** narrative (**$40–60M** valuation framing from executive summary) and **Year 3** ARR for scale story.

3. Data / facts to use

- **ARR: ~$850K → ~$4.0M → ~$17.9M** (Years 1–3).
- **Gross margin: ~60% Y1** → **~74% Y2–Y3**.
- **EBITDA:** Y1 **(~$1.16M loss)**, Y2 **(~$1.38M loss)**, Y3 **~$6.0M profit** (rounded from submission).
- **Monthly cash breakeven: ~Month 26–28**.
- **OpEx:** Y1 **~$2.0M**, Y2 **~$5.4M**, Y3 **~$11.8M**.
- **Enterprise buyer ROI: ~143%** / **~$258K** net value Y1.

4. What this slide is about (lasting message)

High gross margin SaaS, **investment years are intentional**, **profitability emerges in Year 3**. Fill in the ask: **$X seed/Series A for pilots → integration depth → graph flywheel.** Audience should believe **downside is managed** and **upside is venture-scale**.

Slide 10 — Vision, Defensibility & Closing

1. Objective

End on **emotion + mission** and **recall** the wedge.

2. Context and message

Restate **vision** (every career conversation informed; every candidate met as a whole human). Tie to **trust:** audit logs, explainability, bias monitoring, GDPR / EU AI Act alignment—**HR Ops** buyers need **defensibility**. Optional: **Team** slide if the rubric rewards "who can execute."

3. Data / facts to use

- **Vision:** *A world where every person walks into their career conversations fully informed, and every organization meets every candidate as a whole human being—not a resume score.*
- **Mission:** *To give every recruiter and every job seeker an AI Second Brain that does the research, synthesizes the signals, and prepares them for the conversations that matter—so that when humans meet, they connect with clarity, confidence, and context.*
- Compliance: immutable audit logs, approval gates, candidate visibility/corrections where applicable.
- **Illustrative long-term anchor: 7–8× ARR** on Year 3 ARR → **~$125–145M** implied—label clearly as **comparable-multiple illustration**, not a promise.

4. What this slide is about (lasting message)

Last slide is **why this matters ethically and commercially**. The audience remembers HOGH as **the company that scaled empathy and intelligence without automating injustice**—and as a **real startup**, not a homework deck.

Deck hygiene

- **Footnote** industry stats from `research.md` separately from HOGH-specific projections in `submission.md`.
- **One idea per slide** in the room; this document is the **speaker depth**.
- **Live demo:** Keep the interlude **under ~90 seconds** so Slides **6–10** (moat → close) still land; put the real URL in the interlude slide and optionally at the bottom of Slide 5 in speaker notes only.